**25901317 Reg.No : .....**
**Name : .....**

**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**
**MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026**
**Fourth SEMESTER**
**Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG4VACHIS200 - AMBEDKAR: LIFE, POLITICS AND PHILOSOPHY**
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

**Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes** **Maximum Marks: 50**

**Answer key**

Part A
Short Answer Questions
Answer any **5** questions
Each question carries **2** marks

1) Experience marked by Brahmanical dominance, caste oppression, untouchability, social exclusion, and unequal access to education and public life. Struggle for reform, dignity and political, legal and social rights
2) Constitution as a tool of reform, rights, equality and dignity. Constitution as a tool for protection and upliftment. Inability of social reform alone in dismantling caste- need of legal backing.
3) Role of Ambedkar in turning constitution as a tool against caste oppression. Fundamental rights- Article 15, 16, 17.
4) Role of caste in Indian society. Discriminations- untouchability, social segregation, restrictions on/ denial of access to public places, denial of education, occupational stigma, dehumanisation, humiliation, social boycott, exclusion form civic and religious institutions.
5) Ambedkar- rejection of caste and call for its annihilation- caste as structurally rooted in Hindu social order. Gandhi- call for reform within in the Hindu society- emphasis on moral transformation of the oppressor- caste as an evil that can be corrected.
6) The difference in position between Ambedkar and the left. Ambedkar- caste not as a form of class inequality- more rigid, hereditary, and religiously sanctioned system of social division.
7) Industrialisation- necessary for economic modernisation, social mobility, and the weakening of caste-based village structures. Role of industries in creating mobile workforce, expanding employment, and reducing dependence on traditional caste occupations.
8) Measures for labour welfare- regulation of working conditions, maternity benefits, fixed working hours, labour rights. Ambedkar linked labour welfare with social justice- state as an institution responsible for protecting workers.

Part B
Short Essay Questions
Answer any **4** questions
Each question carries **5** marks

9) Legal training as a tool to challenge caste discrimination through legislation, public argument, and constitutional design. Use of legal reasoning to defend rights, logically critique social hierarchy and shape legal protections through the constitution.

10) Ambedkar and the centrality of labour rights to economic progress and democracy. Economic exploitation and social inequality as mutually reinforcing. State intervention in industry. Call for welfare measures.
11) Evaluate level question. Areas where Ambedkar's goals were realised- every citizen is equal in legal terms- constitutional protections, reservation, civil rights, anti-discrimination laws. Areas left unaddressed- law in practice, role of caste in shaping social life, political power, access to resources- violence.
12) Resignation due to slow pace of social reform- unwillingness of dominant political forces to confront patriarchy. Ambedkar's resignation exposed the limits of post-independence reformism, stood as a proof of how strong the conservative forces were in an independent India. Highlighted the commitment of Ambedkar towards women's rights, legal equality, and secular social reform.
13) Ambedkar's conversion to Navayana Buddhism- rejected Hindu ritual hierarchy and spiritual basis of untouchability- questioned caste ridden society and Brahmanical authority- asserted the ability of Dalits to create dignified moral community outside the caste order and claim self-respect through a new religious identity.
14) Social democracy- commitment towards Liberty, equality, fraternity and belief in social efficiency through harnessing the maximum potential of an individual. Ambedkar's nationalism- argued for social justice- without social justice nationalism remained hollow and reproduced caste domination and class elites.
15) Equality of opportunity- same access to education, jobs, public life etc... Equality of outcome- social and material results being equal. Historical disadvantage. Need for affirmative action.

Part C

Essay Questions

Answer any 2 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

16) Ambedkar's emphasis on safeguards against majoritarian domination, equal citizenship, constitutional protection, political representation, rights-based democracy, and fraternity. Need for inclusion- essential for nation building.
17) Ambedkar's critique of caste- exposed caste as a system of graded inequality- role of religion, endogamy and social power in sustaining the system. Solution- legal rights, social reform, education, political representation, moral transformation- equality transformed to a structural goal rather than philosophical.
18) Navayana- ethical and political alternative to Brahmanical authority- stress on equality- repurposing of Buddhist ideas to achieve social justice and dignity- new identity to Dalits and their struggles- role in community mobilisation and anti-caste struggle.
19) addressed institutionalising equality, fundamental rights, abolition of untouchability, reservations, and democratic safeguards. But a constitution is as good as those enacting it and following it. Problems with implementation- caste, patriarchy, domination by majority and inequality are still realities.